

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-I.9: The Perfect Active System

Retrieve perfect stems and distinguish perfect, pluperfect, future perfect, and imperfect viewpoints in connected clauses

Stage	Stage I — Foundations
Prerequisite	EL-I.8 mastery: classify conjugations and parse the active present system
Next	EL-I.10, Passive Voice and Deponents

Read *EL-GUIDE: Start Here* before using this packet. Course method, pacing, source conventions, and answer protocol are stated there; this module begins with its lesson and assumes previously taught terms.

Contents

I	Lesson	1
1	Unit 9: The Perfect Active System	1
1.1	One stem, three tenses	1
1.2	Handwritten study and controlled composition	2
II	Practice	3
1	Transfer, retrieval, and application	3
1.1	One stem, three tenses — transfer practice	3
1.2	Handwritten study and controlled composition — transfer practice	3
III	Worksheets	4
1	Unit 9: The Perfect Active System	4
	Worksheet I.33 — Variant A	4
	Worksheet I.36 — Variant D	5
IV	Assessment	6
1	Mastery assessment and record	6
V	Answer Key	7
1	Practice models and rubrics	7
2	Unit 9: The Perfect Active System	8
	Solution I.33 — Variant A	8
	Solution I.36 — Variant D	9
VI	Scope and Sources	10
1	Scope and Qualifications	10
1.1	Packet boundary	10
1.2	Controlling records and local state	10
2	References	10
2.1	Primary corpus	10
2.2	Grammar and lexicography	11
2.3	Citation convention	11
3	Generation Metadata	11

Part I

Lesson

CHAPTER 1

Unit 9: The Perfect Active System

On completing this unit, you can:

- derive a perfect stem from the third principal part;
- form the perfect, pluperfect, and future perfect active indicative;
- contrast completed action with imperfect action; and
- parse common perfect verbs in the Creed, Gloria, and Vulgate.

1.1 One stem, three tenses

The third principal part is the first-person singular perfect active. Remove final *-i* to find the perfect stem: *laudavi* gives *laudav-*; *monui* gives *monu-*; *rexi* gives *rex-*; *cepi* gives *cep-*; *audivi* gives *audiv-*. Perfect stems must be learned from principal parts rather than guessed from conjugation.

	1 sg.	2 sg.	3 sg.	1 pl.	2 pl.	3 pl.
Perfect endings	-i	-isti	-it	-imus	-istis	-erunt
<i>laudo</i>	laudavi	laudavisti	laudavit	laudavimus	laudavistis	laudaverunt
Pluperfect	laudaveram	laudaveras	laudaverat	laudaveramus	laudaveratis	laudaverant
Future perfect	laudavero	laudaveris	laudaverit	laudaverimus	laudaveritis	laudaverint

The three tenses order completed actions from different reference points. The **perfect** presents an action as completed relative to the present or as a completed past event; the **pluperfect** presents it as completed before another past point; the **future perfect** presents it as completed before a future point. The alternative third-person plural perfect ending *-ere* occurs in Latin generally, though *-erunt* is the safer production form. The perfect reports a completed past event, often “did” or “has done”; the pluperfect reports an event already completed before another past point, “had done”; the future perfect reports completion before a future point, “will have done”. In contrast, the imperfect normally presents a past action as continuing, repeated, or incomplete.

Worked example: *Et resurrexit tertia die, secundum Scripturas*

Worked passage ID: *W.I.35*; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

resurrexit, from *resurgo*, *resurgere*, *resurrexi*, *resurrectum*, is third-person singular perfect active indicative. The subject is Christ, carried from the preceding Creed. Translation: “And he rose again on the third day, according to the Scriptures.”

Worked example: *Resurrexit, sicut dixit*

Worked passage ID: W.I.36; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Both *resurrexit* and *dixit* are third-person singular perfect active indicative; *dixit* comes from *dico, dicere, dixi, dictum*. Translation: “He has risen, as he said.”

Worked example: *Fecit potentiam in brachio suo; dispersit superbos mente cordis sui*

Worked passage ID: W.I.37; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

fecit, from *facio, facere, feci, factum*, and *dispersit*, from *dispergo, dispergere, dispersi, dispersum*, are third-person singular perfect active. Their understood subject is God. *potentiam* and substantival *superbos*, “the proud”, are objects. Translation: “He has shown might with his arm; he has scattered the proud in the thought of their heart.”

Worked example: *Deposuit potentes de sede, et exaltavit humiles*

Worked passage ID: W.I.38; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

deposuit and *exaltavit* are third-person singular perfect active. Substantival *potentes* and *humiles* are accusative plural objects: “He has put down the mighty from their seat and exalted the lowly.”

Worked example: *In principio creavit Deus cælum et terram* (Gen 1:1)

Worked passage ID: W.I.39; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

creavit is third-person singular perfect active; ending *-it* agrees with singular subject *Deus*. Neuter *cælum* and feminine *terram* are coordinated accusative objects. Translation: “In the beginning God created heaven and earth.”

Worked example: *Vidi aquam egredientem de templo*

Worked passage ID: W.I.40; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

vidi, from *video, videre, vidi, visum*, is first-person singular perfect active, “I saw”. *aquam* is its object; participle *egredientem* agrees with *aquam* and means “coming forth”. Translation: “I saw water coming forth from the temple.”

1.2 Handwritten study and controlled composition

For ten verbs, copy all four principal parts and box the perfect stem. Write the three perfect-system paradigms of *laudo*, then repeat with the unpredictable stems *fec-*, *dix-*, and *vid-*. Make a two-column timeline contrasting *laudabat*, “he was praising”, with *laudavit*, “he praised”. Compose “God created the world”, *Deus mundum creavit*; “we had heard the word”, *Verbum audiveramus*; and “they will have praised the Lord”, *Dominum laudaverint*.

Part II

Practice

CHAPTER 1

Transfer, retrieval, and application

1.1 One stem, three tenses — transfer practice

Connection. An irregular-stem retrieval card ties each perfect form to its actual third principal part rather than a guessed present stem.

Transfer task. Using only verbs printed in the lesson, make cards with present headword on the front and third principal part, recovered perfect stem, third singular perfect, and first plural pluperfect on the back. Test the irregular cards twice.

Retrieval check. State how to recover the stem and why conjugation number alone cannot predict it.

1.2 Handwritten study and controlled composition — transfer practice

Connection. A reference-point timeline prevents perfect, pluperfect, future perfect, and imperfect from collapsing into an undifferentiated past.

Transfer task. Place the lesson's perfect/imperfect contrast on a line, then add one lesson-derived pluperfect event before a past reference point and one future-perfect event before a future reference point. Label completion and reference point separately.

Retrieval check. Define each perfect-system tense by its relation to a reference point, not by an English auxiliary alone.

Part III

Worksheets

CHAPTER 1

Unit 9: The Perfect Active System

Worksheet I.33 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: I.33

Focus: Perfect stems, endings, and completed action

Use: Show the third principal part used for every irregular stem.

1. Derive perfect stems from *laudavi*, *monui*, *rexi*, *cepi*, *audivi*, *dixi*.

-
2. Write all six perfect active indicative forms of *laudo*.

-
3. Give 1 singular, 2 plural, and 3 plural pluperfect and future perfect of *audio*.

-
4. Contrast *laudabat* with *laudavit* in form and aspect.

-
5. Correct *heri Deum laudabit*, intended “yesterday he praised God”.

-
6. **Text:** *Resurrexit, sicut dixit*.

Passage ID: I.33.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

This is an excerpt of the traditional *Regina cæli* antiphon whose controlling edition remains unresolved; parse both verbs and translate.

Worksheet I.36 — Variant D**Worksheet ID:** I.36**Focus:** Perfect versus imperfect and coordinated completed acts**Use:** This variant is an independent mastery sample.

1. Write all persons of the pluperfect and future perfect of *rego* using perfect stem *rex-*.
-

2. Classify and translate *creabat*, *creavit*, *creaverat*, *creaverit*.
-

3. Give the alternative third-person plural perfect ending and form it from *laudav-*; state the preferred production form.
-

4. Translate “he said”, “we had done”, “they have come”, and “I shall have heard”.
-

5. Diagnose *heri videbamus aquam et vidimus templum* if both acts are presented as single completed events.
-

6. **Text:** *Deposuit potentes de sede, et exaltavit humiles.*

Passage ID: I.36.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse verbs and substantival adjectives; identify the governed phrase and translate.

Part IV

Assessment

CHAPTER 1

Mastery assessment and record

Advance when: Recover at least eleven of twelve perfect stems, form at least 27 of 30 requested perfect-system forms, and distinguish perfect from imperfect in at least nine of ten contextual sentences with a defensible time relation.

Complete the assessment before opening the answer part. Record evidence, not confidence or elapsed time.

Evidence	First attempt	Delayed check
Date and conditions		
Worksheet ID and score		
Mastery task and result		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or remediation item used		

If the criterion is met: continue to EL-I.10, Passive Voice and Deponents.

If it is not met: Worksheets I.34 and I.35 remain optional remediation or delayed-recall variants.

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:** _____

Reason in one complete sentence: _____

Part V

Answer Key

Open this part only after completing the assessment record. Use the comparison and alternative-answer protocol in EL-GUIDE.

CHAPTER 1

Practice models and rubrics

One stem, three tenses — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. Each card removes final *-i* from the third principal part to recover the perfect stem and then adds the correct perfect-system material. A complete explanation notes that sound changes and suppletion make many perfect stems lexical facts learned from principal parts.

Handwritten study and controlled composition — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. Perfect presents completion relative to the present or as a bounded past event; pluperfect places completion before a past reference point; future perfect places it before a future point. Imperfect presents past action as ongoing, repeated, or incomplete. The Latin forms and proposed English must agree with those relations.

CHAPTER 2

Unit 9: The Perfect Active System

Solution I.33 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: I.33

Focus: Perfect stems, endings, and completed action**Use:** Show the third principal part used for every irregular stem.

1. Derive perfect stems from *laudavi*, *monui*, *rexī*, *cepi*, *audivi*, *dixi*.
Answer / model: *laudav-*, *monu-*, *rex-*, *cep-*, *audiv-*, *dix-*.
2. Write all six perfect active indicative forms of *laudo*.
Answer / model: *laudavi*, *laudavisti*, *laudavit*, *laudavimus*, *laudavistis*, *laudaverunt*.
3. Give 1 singular, 2 plural, and 3 plural pluperfect and future perfect of *audio*.
Answer / model: Pluperfect: *audiveram*, *audiveratis*, *audiverant*. Future perfect: *audivero*, *audiveritis*, *audiverint*.
4. Contrast *laudabat* with *laudavit* in form and aspect.
Answer / model: *laudabat*: 3 singular imperfect active indicative, “was praising/used to praise”; *laudavit*: 3 singular perfect active indicative, “praised/has praised”. The former views action as ongoing or repeated, the latter as complete.
5. Correct *heri Deum laudabit*, intended “yesterday he praised God”.
Answer / model: *Heri Deum laudavit*. *Laudabit* is future; completed past requires perfect *laudavit*.
6. **Text:** *Resurrexit, sicut dixit*.
Passage ID: I.33.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
This is an excerpt of the traditional *Regina cæli* antiphon whose controlling edition remains unresolved; parse both verbs and translate.
Answer / notes: *resurrexit*: 3 singular perfect active indicative of *resurgo*, *resurgere*, *resurrexi*; *dixit*: 3 singular perfect active indicative of *dico*, *dicere*, *dixi*. “He has risen, as he said.”

Solution I.36 — Variant D

Worksheet ID: I.36

Focus: Perfect versus imperfect and coordinated completed acts

Use: This variant is an independent mastery sample.

1. Write all persons of the pluperfect and future perfect of *rego* using perfect stem *rex-*.

Answer / model: Pluperfect: *rexeram, rexeras, rexerat, rexeramus, rexeratis, rexerant*. Future perfect: *rexero, rexeris, rexerit, rexerimus, rexeritis, rexerint*.

2. Classify and translate *creabat, creavit, creaverat, creaverit*.

Answer / model: 3 singular imperfect “was creating”; 3 singular perfect “created/has created”; 3 singular pluperfect “had created”; 3 singular future perfect “will have created”.

3. Give the alternative third-person plural perfect ending and form it from *laudav-*; state the preferred production form.

Answer / model: Alternative ending *-ere*: *laudavere*. Preferred production form: *laudaverunt*.

4. Translate “he said”, “we had done”, “they have come”, and “I shall have heard”.

Answer / model: *dixit; feceramus; venerunt; audivero*.

5. Diagnose *heri videbamus aquam et vidimus templum* if both acts are presented as single completed events.

Answer / model: *Heri vidimus aquam et vidimus templum*. Imperfect *videbamus* would present the first seeing as ongoing/repeated; perfect presents both as completed.

6. **Text:** *Deposuit potentes de sede, et exaltavit humiles*.

Passage ID: I.36.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse verbs and substantival adjectives; identify the governed phrase and translate.

Answer / notes: *deposuit, exaltavit*: 3 singular perfect active indicative with understood divine subject. *potentes, humiles*: masculine/feminine plural accusative substantival adjectives, direct objects. *de sede*: ablative after *de*. “He has put down the mighty from their seat and exalted the lowly.”

Part VI

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-I.9, *The Perfect Active System*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative lesson, transfer practice for its internal submodules, two selected worksheets, one local mastery assessment, and matching solutions. This packet teaches active perfect-system morphology and basic aspectual contrast; later contexts may require more nuanced English tense choices.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. EL-GUIDE owns the course-wide study method, pacing, lookup discipline, answer protocol, source classes, and advancement rules; this packet assumes that orientation and terminology taught in prerequisite modules.

1.2 Controlling records and local state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and transfer practice. EL-GUIDE owns the corpus, normalization, translation, non-authority, review, and answer conventions that apply here. Claim-local qualifications remain beside the affected material; check received wording against the course-wide passage inventory.

Any installed snapshot is a working study held from release until its exact bytes and outstanding distribution gates receive separate authorization.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.

- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

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Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum structure audit, shared typesetting and selection correction, rendered-structure regression checks, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum Part-scoped numbering and rendered contents hierarchy correction, rendered contents-geometry regression checking, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (starter-guide consolidation, module-flow and definition-retrieval revision, stage-boundary assessment correction, catalog and audit records, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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